

# PICK SIX PREVIEWS

2026 COLLEGE FOOTBALL SEASON PREVIEW

ALL 68 POWER 4  
TEAMS

CONFERENCE  
PREDICTIONS

GAME GRADER  
FORMULA

THE 12-TEAM  
PLAYOFF ERA

10-YEAR OFFENSE  
& DEFENSE TRENDS

**#1** MOST ACCURATE  
POWER 4 PREVIEW  
SINCE 2012



HEISMAN  
TROPHY®  
VOTER



## BRETT CIANCIA





# INTRODUCTION

BRETT CIANCIA @PickSixPreviews



## ABOUT PICK SIX PREVIEWS

In 2012, I launched Pick Six Previews with co-founder Mike Nowoswiat. Over the past ten seasons (2016-2025), our college football predictions have been rated the #1 “Most Accurate” in the nation by Stassen.com who has been tracking prediction accuracy for decades.

Our daily, original content on Twitter has built a following of 100,000+ college football fans. That includes hundreds of Division 1 coaches/coordinators, former Heisman winners, thousands of current/former college players, thousands of high school recruits, and tens of thousands of passionate football fans.

After the release of my 2019 & 2020 Season Preview books, I was selected to become a Heisman Trophy voter, and invited to join the 12-person FWAA All-America Team selection committee. I’m a voter on several other national awards such as the Biletnikoff, Outland, and Nagurski and have a weekly ballot in the FWAA’s Super 16 poll.

2022 was the first season I was eligible for all three of Stassen’s accuracy intervals (10-year, 5-year, 3-year) and I placed **#1 in all three**. This marked just the 3<sup>rd</sup> “Triple Crown Winner” in Stassen’s 30+ years of magazine tracking.

## WELCOME TO THE 2026 PREVIEW

I’d first like to thank every single one of our followers, fans, listeners, and now most importantly YOU – the reader! There are so many options out there for sports content, so I truly appreciate you picking me. I appreciate every retweet, message, and comment because this has been an organic movement on Twitter since launch day 2012.

Over the past six months, I have spent over 1,000 hours producing everything you find in these 170 pages. To my knowledge, this is the only college football preview magazine out there that is a one-man operation.

This includes hundreds of hours of game tape, spring games, podcasts by local media, calls with beat writers, calls with head coaches and coordinators, writing, editing, designing the pages, accumulating the stats/data, designing the graphics, developing my advanced stats, developing my Game Grader formula, talking on 200+ radio/podcast segments, and keeping the Twitter feed filled with daily, original content.

The goal was to take a deep dive into all 68 Power 4 programs, develop next-level stats and graphics, and give the college football fan the most complete, and up-to-date preseason publication possible. Again here in 2026, I am confident I have achieved that goal.

If you enjoy the book, please be sure to tweet at me, share it on social media, and spread the word to your college football friends. As I said, this has been a Twitter movement from the start and I appreciate every single one of you.

**NEW in 2025:** I launched a weekly, in-season product Pick Six PLUS. Everything you love about the magazine, but now updated weekly in the fall, and emailed out every Tuesday. The season moves so fast, but PLUS provides the most complete set of stats & information on all 68 Power 4 teams. I encourage you to check out the samples here in the magazine, and at [picksixpreviews.com/plus](https://picksixpreviews.com/plus) **NEW in 2026:** added a Non-AQ (Full FBS) PLUS package

## THANK YOU

Thank you to my wife, my family, and friends who have supported Pick Six Previews over the years.

Thank you to Mike Nowoswiat – an incredible football mind, creative thinker, and an even better friend.

Thank you to David Jones – mentor, friend, and fellow Chester County college football expert.

Thank you to Chris Fallica, Josh Pate, Scott Van Pelt, Stanford Steve & Tim Murray for the thoughtful testimonials.

Thank you to my mom for the inspiration and especially my dad for introducing me to college football, helping build my knowledge base from a young age, and spending so many fall Saturdays together.

## ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

I personally completed everything in this publication except for the following:

- The helmet logos on team pages should be regarded as property of the respective colleges -- found on Charles Arey’s “Helmet Project”
- The returning production percentage stat was published by Bill Connelly







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BRETT CIANCIA @PickSixPreviews

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# TESTIMONIALS & RADIO TOUR



"Few publications have as up-to-date preview information as Pick Six Previews. In addition to all the usual content one would expect out of a preview magazine, there are unique features like "Game Grader" which help Pick Six Previews stand out. It's not easy to make a preview publication seem fresh and full of new information, but Brett Ciancia accomplishes it with some incredibly thorough write-ups. If you're getting ready for college football season, **Pick Six Previews is a must read.**" - Chris Fallica

**CHRIS FALLICA** -- ESPN's *COLLEGE GAMEDAY* (1996-2022) & FOX SPORTS (2023-2026)



"**Pick Six Previews is a really good product** -- I would encourage you, if you are into the deeper, more analytical dives, unique angles, a little more meat-on-the-bones than what you get in your typical preview magazine, go check it out" - Josh Pate

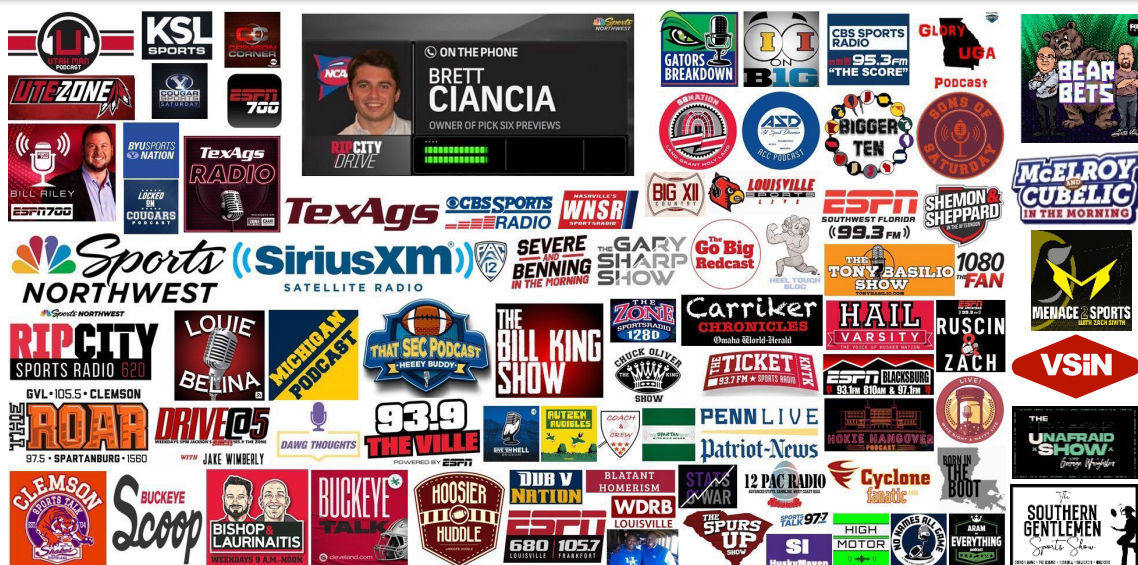
**JOSH PATE** - ANALYST AND HOST OF *JOSH PATE'S COLLEGE FOOTBALL SHOT*



"Pick Six Previews is the best thing I go to for season prep" - STANFORD STEVE, ESPN

"This is red meat for college football fans – the best" - SCOTT VAN PELT, ESPN

"Pick Six is the best magazine in the college football preview industry" – BRANDON WALKER, BARSTOOL

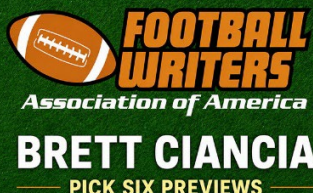


Since the release of my 2023 Season Preview book, I have been invited onto 200+ radio, TV, and podcast spots.

**THANK YOU** to all Radio/Podcast Producers, Hosts and Listeners.



# 2026 FWAA RISING STAR WINNER



**2026 EDWARD ASCHOFF  
RISING STAR AWARD WINNER**

Press release from FWAA on July 2, 2026 by Steve Richardson

## Cincia named Rising Star Award recipient

**DALLAS (FWAA)** – **Brett Cincia**, the founder and owner of Pick Six Previews, is the seventh winner of the **Edward Aschoff Rising Star Award**, which is presented annually by the Football Writers Association of America. The award is named after Edward Aschoff, the beloved ESPN college football reporter who died on Christmas Eve in 2019 on his 34th birthday from previously undetected Stage 4 non-Hodgkin's lymphoma in his lungs.

"I am extremely honored to be selected for the Rising Star award," Cincia said. "It has been a long road building Pick Six Previews from scratch, and I'm thankful for everyone

who has supported me along the way, all the readers and especially David Jones for his nomination and mentorship. Given the national scope of the preview magazine, it has been a pleasure to connect with so many of our FWAA members over the years.

"Though I never met Ed, his colleagues mention his passion, work-ethic, and authenticity which are inspirational traits to all writers young and old. It's an honor to be named alongside Ed and those who have won the award before me."

FWAA 2017 President Dave Jones from PennLive.com nominated Cincia, now 33, who launched his predictive Pick Six Previews in 2012 when he was a sophomore business major at Boston College. "I nominated him for his trailblazing in analytics," Jones said. "It's one thing to be young and gifted. It's another to innovate at such a young age. I believe he will soon become known as the Ken Pomeroy of college football.

"A one-man show," Jones said, "he writes comprehensive previews for all 68 Power 4 teams while striking a balance between program trends, coaching schemes, player personnel and his proprietary stats."

Cincia has garnered plaudits from many other insiders in college football such as Chris Fallica and Josh Pate.

"Few publications have as up-to-date preview information as Pick Six Previews," Fox Sports' Fallica said. "In addition to all of the usual content one would expect out of a preview magazine, there are unique features like 'Game Grader', which help Pick Six Previews stand out. It is not easy to make a preview publication seem fresh and full of new information, but Brett Cincia accomplishes it with some incredibly thorough writeups."

Over the course of the last 10 seasons (2016-25), Cincia's pre-season picks have cumulatively been the most accurate in college football as deemed by Stassen, who has graded pre-season publications since the 1990s. Athlon and Phil Steele Magazines have ranked second and third over that period. Cincia's pre-game pick for the national title game was Indiana 27, Miami (Fla.) 17. The final score was Indiana 27, Miami (Fla.) 22

Other very accurate predictions by Cincia during last season's playoffs:

His Quarterfinal Sugar Bowl Prediction: Ole Miss 35, Georgia 34. Result: Ole Miss 39, Georgia 34.

His Semifinal Fiesta Bowl Prediction: Miami (Fla.) 31, Ole Miss 26. Result: Miami (Fla.) 31, Ole Miss 27.

Cincia's work extends to the regular season and playoffs when he writes weekly stat packages and previews of upcoming games.

"It is an all-out sprint from Week Zero until the confetti falls on the national title stage," Cincia said. "It is a weekly flow of watching games all Saturday, compiling my weekly Pick Six Plus stat package, talking on radio and podcasts, then writing more about upcoming games. Then it is Saturday morning again."

"My dad introduced me to college football, and I loved everything about it--the traditions, rivalries, the style of play, and its unique spot in American history," Cincia said. "My passion for the sport, matched with my analytical mindset, led to a set of stats that are insightful, interesting, and predictive. My preview magazine brings those stats to life to help explain what happened and what to expect in the fall. I love diving deep into every program and it's a basically never-ending research project.

"I played football at Unionville High School (Pa.)," he added, "and the sport instilled an unrelenting work ethic. I've always enjoyed the X's and O's, and one of the best parts of my preview magazine process is talking to FBS head coaches and coordinators about their schemes and program strategies."

Shehan Jeyarajah of CBS Sports, current 2026 FWAA President, was last year's Rising Star recipient. Other past winners include: Nick Kelly, now of AL.com, The Advocate's Wilson Alexander (2023), Sports Illustrated's Richard Johnson (2022), The Athletic's Grace Raynor (2021) and The Athletic's David Ubben (2020) – the first recipient of the Edward Aschoff Rising Star Award.

## Remembering Edward Aschoff



Edward Aschoff

Aschoff graduated from the University of Florida in 2008 with a bachelor's degree in journalism. After covering Gators football, basketball and baseball from 2007 to 2011 for The Gainesville Sun, he joined ESPN in 2011 as an SEC reporter and distinguished himself as a rising star.

Aschoff inspired us through his storytelling, brightened our lives with his gregarious personality, and uplifted our spirits with his energy. The FWAA hopes to honor his memory and his commitment to aspiring journalists with this award.

"Edward epitomized everything you want in a sports journalist: He knew how to build relationships, to gain trust, to break stories but also to tell stories," said ESPN.com's Andrea Adelson, 2024 FWAA President. "And he did it all with a flair that made you want to watch his television pieces or read his written stories right away. His dogged determination and relentless work ethic allowed him to rise to the top at ESPN, and all his exemplary qualities serve as a model for young journalists everywhere about what truly can be achieved if you go after what you want."

"Edward was one of our stars – not just because he was so talented as a journalist and storyteller, but also because of everything he did to help people around him. He always had a good word of advice for young journalists, he was always willing to give back, and he always made people smile," said Ted Spiker, chair of the department of journalism at the University of Florida who taught Edward in several classes at UF.

Founded in 1941, the **Football Writers Association of America** consists of journalists, broadcasters, publicists, photographers and key executives in all areas of college football. The FWAA works to govern media access and game-day operations while presenting awards and honors, including an annual All-America team. For more information about the FWAA and its programs and initiatives, contact Executive Director Steve Richardson at 214-870-6516 or [tiger@fwaa.com](mailto:tiger@fwaa.com).





# COACH CALLS & HEISMAN

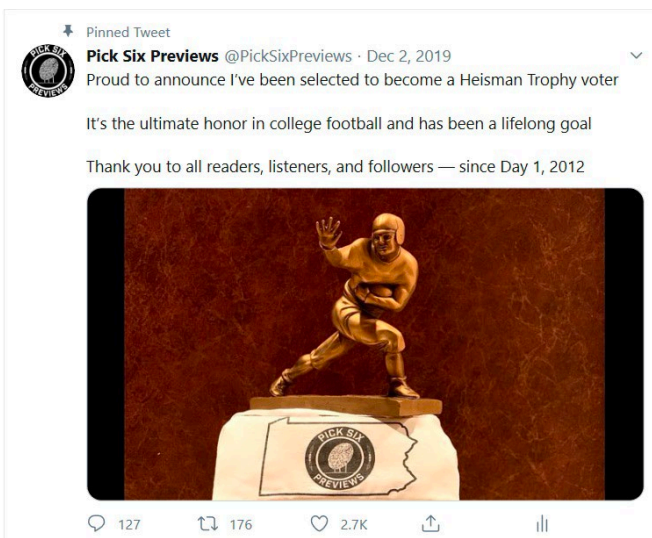
In college football there is widespread variation, and infinite formulas to arrive at the same endpoint of winning football. Mike Leach threw the ball 50 times per game. Iowa almost exclusively throws to tight ends. Bill Snyder's teams used to run the quarterback more than the running backs. Nebraska and Notre Dame have to recruit coast-to-coast, while Miami and USC can walk around the block and pick up 20 blue-chippers.

Part of the research for my annual season preview book includes calls with head coaches and coordinators across the Power 4 landscape for valuable program insights.

THANK YOU to all coaches, coordinators, sports information directors, and athletic directors!



Lincoln Riley, USC head coach  
Kirk Ferentz, Iowa head coach  
Joey McGuire, Texas Tech head coach  
Kalani Sitake, BYU head coach  
Jeff Brohm, Louisville head coach  
PJ Fleck, Minnesota head coach  
Bret Bielema, Illinois head coach  
Pat Narduzzi, Pittsburgh head coach  
Rhett Lashlee, SMU head coach  
Dave Doeren, NC State head coach  
Dave Aranda, Baylor head coach  
Mike Locksley, Maryland head coach  
Sonny Dykes, TCU head coach  
Mike Elko, Texas A&M head coach  
Jake Dickert, Wake Forest head coach  
Jedd Fisch, Washington head coach  
Lance Leipold, Kansas head coach  
Tosh Lupoi, California head coach  
Willie Fritz, Houston head coach  
Will Stein, Kentucky head coach  
Eric Morris, Oklahoma St head coach  
Tavita Pritchard, Stanford head coach  
Morgan Scalley, Utah head coach  
Brent Pry, Virginia Tech defensive coord.  
Tony White, Florida St defensive coord.  
Andy Kotelnicki, Kansas offensive coord.  
Brian Hartline, USF head coach  
Phil Longo, Sam Houston head coach  
Chip Kelly, NW offensive coord.  
Ryan Walters, UW defensive coord  
Tony Gibson, Marshall head coach  
Matt Entz, Fresno State head coach



*"Brett Ciancia is on the way to becoming the Ken Pomeroy of college football. I was blown away by his dedicated research and commitment the first time I saw how much work he sinks into Pick Six Previews. That's why I immediately made him a Heisman Trophy voter in Pennsylvania." - David Jones*



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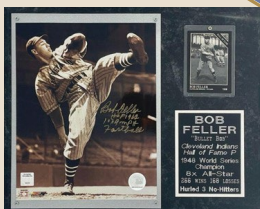
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# PICK SIX PLUS

The "Most Accurate College Football Preview" over the past decade added an in-season weekly supplement: Pick Six PLUS

Pick Six PLUS is everything you love about the preview magazine, but in a weekly format:

- 68 Team Pages - advanced stat profiles for every Power 4 team *and* their weekly opponent, Game Grader projections, advanced game logs, ATS trends, series history, talent matchup, and much more.
- Prior Week Game Results (all Power 4 games) - score, ATS, Game Grader, and advanced stats
- Current Week Preview (all Power 4 games) - Game Grader projection, ATS, opponent-adjusted rankings
- 4 Conference Pages - information and rankings from a league scope
- Game Logs, Team Schedules, TV Schedule, Current Playoff Projection, Pick Six Coordinator of the Week, and more

# PICK SIX PLUS \$99

**SAMPLE EDITION PDF, INFO, AND ORDERS AT [PICKSIXPREVIEWS.COM/PLUS](https://picksixpreviews.com/plus)**

Pick Six PLUS is **emailed every Tuesday** during the 16-week regular season, a bowl edition, and extended Playoff editions. Additionally, if purchased before 8/15/2025 two bonus features are included:

- "Best Season Win Totals" Article
- Advanced Rosters for all 68 Power Teams (see below)

## ADVANCED ROSTERS PICK SIX PLUS

The Transfer Portal Era has made it impossible to keep track of recruits, transfers, and who's who on the starting lineup and two-deep. Pick Six PLUS subscribers get my "Advanced Rosters" for all 68 Power 4 teams. Rather than just the standard names/heights/weights, these pack in more information.

All 22 starters and their backups are included and the visual helps show returning starters, all-conference performers, and projected 2027 NFL Draft picks. It shows what they were rated as high school recruits or as transfers, and how they performed at their prior school.

**SAMPLE EDITION PDF, INFO, AND ORDERS AT [PICKSIXPREVIEWS.COM/PLUS](https://picksixpreviews.com/plus)**

| FLORIDA         |                      |         |             | ADVANCED TWO-DEEP |                   |         |             |
|-----------------|----------------------|---------|-------------|-------------------|-------------------|---------|-------------|
| STARTING LINEUP |                      |         |             | DEPTH             |                   |         |             |
| PICK SIX PLUS   |                      |         |             | PICK SIX PLUS     |                   |         |             |
|                 | 2025                 | RECRUIT | TRANSFER IN |                   | 2025              | RECRUIT | TRANSFER IN |
| QB              | DJ LAGWAY            |         |             | QB                | AIDAN WARNER      |         |             |
| RB              | JADAN BAUGH          |         |             | RB                | JA'KOB JACKSON    |         |             |
| WR              | J MICHAEL STURDIVANT |         |             | WR                | VERNELL BROWN     |         |             |
| WR              | EUGENE WILSON        |         |             | WR                | KAHLEIL JACKSON   |         |             |
| WR              | DALLAS WILSON        |         |             | WR                | AIDAN MIZELL      |         |             |
| TE              | HAYDEN HANSEN        |         |             | TE                | AMIR JACKSON      |         |             |
| OL              | JAKE SLAUGHTER       |         |             | OL                | FLETCHER WESTPHAL |         |             |
| OL              | AUSTIN BARBER        |         |             | OL                | KAMRYN WAITES     |         |             |
| OL              | KNIEAH HARRIS        |         |             | OL                | JASON ZANDAMELA   |         |             |
| OL              | DAMIEON GEORGE       |         |             | OL                | DEVON MANUEL      |         |             |
| OL              | BRYCE LOVETT         |         |             | OL                | RODERICK KEARNY   |         |             |

| FLORIDA         |                |         |             | ADVANCED TWO-DEEP |                 |         |             |
|-----------------|----------------|---------|-------------|-------------------|-----------------|---------|-------------|
| STARTING LINEUP |                |         |             | DEPTH             |                 |         |             |
| PICK SIX PLUS   |                |         |             | PICK SIX PLUS     |                 |         |             |
|                 | 2025           | RECRUIT | TRANSFER IN |                   | 2025            | RECRUIT | TRANSFER IN |
| DL              | CALEB BANKS    |         |             | DL                | LI MCCRAY       |         |             |
| DL              | TYREAK SAPP    |         |             | DL                | KAMRAN JAMES    |         |             |
| DL              | JAMARI LYONS   |         |             | DL                | Michai Boireau  |         |             |
| DL              | GEORGE GUMBS   |         |             | DL                | JALEN WIGGINS   |         |             |
| LB              | GRAYSON HOWARD |         |             | LB                | JADEN ROBINSON  |         |             |
| LB              | MYLES GRAHAM   |         |             | LB                | AARON CHILES    |         |             |
| DB              | DEVIN MOORE    |         |             | DB                | AARON GATES     |         |             |
| DB              | DIJON JOHNSON  |         |             | DB                | CORMANI McCLAIN |         |             |
| DB              | JORDAN CASTELL |         |             | DB                | LAGONZA HAYWARD |         |             |
| DB              | BRYCE THORNTON |         |             | DB                | DRAKE STUBBS    |         |             |
| DB              | SHARIF DENSON  |         |             | DB                | BEN HANKS       |         |             |





# PICK SIX PLUS - SAMPLE TEAM PAGE

**INDIANA****15-0 (9-0)**

RECORD (BIG TEN)

**#1**

OVERALL 2025

**#1**

LAST 4 GAMES

GAME GRADER RANKINGS of 68 POWER 4

**PICK SIX PLUS**

MEMORIAL STADIUM

CAPACITY: 52,959 #47

HEAD COACH: CURT CIGNETTI

OC: MIKE SHANAHAN DC: BRYANT HAINES

**STAT PROFILE**

| INDIANA         | RANK / 136 |
|-----------------|------------|
| Scoring Offense | 42.6 ppg 2 |
| Points per Play | 0.64 2     |
| Total Offense   | 461 ypg 11 |
| Yards per Play  | 7.0 7      |
| Rushing Offense | 218 ypg 12 |
| Yards per Carry | 5.3 14     |
| O-Line Run Push | 4.8 14     |
| Explosive Rush  | 6.9 24     |
| Passing Offense | 243 ypg 54 |
| Yards / Attempt | 9.6 2      |
| QB Rating       | 190 1      |
| TD / INT Ratio  | 6.6 3      |
| Sacks / Attempt | 6% 58      |
| Explosive Pass  | 10.1 8     |

| INDIANA         | RANK / 136 |
|-----------------|------------|
| Scoring Defense | 11.1 ppg 2 |
| Points per Play | 0.2 3      |
| Total Defense   | 261 ypg 4  |
| Yards per Play  | 4.6 9      |
| 3rd Down Conv%  | 30% 8      |
| Rushing Defense | 75 ypg 2   |
| Yards per Carry | 2.9 7      |
| Negative Play % | 15% 1      |
| Explosive Rush  | 3.8 4      |
| Passing Defense | 186 ypg 23 |
| Yards / Attempt | 6.1 16     |
| QB Rating       | 112 12     |
| Completion %    | 62% 72     |
| Explosive Pass  | 4.5 18     |

**OPPONENT STAT PROFILE**

| MIAMI           | RANK / 136  |
|-----------------|-------------|
| Scoring Offense | 31.6 ppg 30 |
| Points per Play | 0.47 33     |
| Total Offense   | 409 ypg 41  |
| Yards per Play  | 6.1 34      |
| Rushing Offense | 155 ypg 72  |
| Yards per Carry | 4.3 76      |
| O-Line Run Push | 4.4 48      |
| Explosive Rush  | 4.3 111     |
| Passing Offense | 255 ypg 38  |
| Yards / Attempt | 8.2 25      |
| QB Rating       | 159 12      |
| TD / INT Ratio  | 2.8 36      |
| Sacks / Attempt | 4% 20       |
| Explosive Pass  | 7.3 49      |

| MIAMI           | RANK / 136 |
|-----------------|------------|
| Scoring Defense | 14 ppg 5   |
| Points per Play | 0.23 5     |
| Total Defense   | 293 ypg 11 |
| Yards per Play  | 4.7 14     |
| 3rd Down Conv%  | 31% 11     |
| Rushing Defense | 86 ypg 6   |
| Yards per Carry | 3.0 10     |
| Negative Play % | 10% 11     |
| Explosive Rush  | 5.2 30     |
| Passing Defense | 206 ypg 45 |
| Yards / Attempt | 6.3 23     |
| QB Rating       | 115 17     |
| Completion %    | 60% 40     |
| Explosive Pass  | 4.4 12     |

| INDIANA                     | RANK / 68 |
|-----------------------------|-----------|
| Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play |           |
| Offense Overall             | 6         |
| Rushing Offense             | 1.1 13    |
| Passing Offense             | 60.7 1    |
| Defense Overall             | 12        |
| Rushing Defense             | 1.4 5     |
| Passing Defense             | 26.6 9    |

29.5 SECONDS/PLAY

#63 OF 68

SLOW

MATCHUP PROJECTION via GAME GRADER

29.8 SECONDS/PLAY

#65 OF 68

SLOW

|         | Rank / 68 | Rating | Projection | VEGAS SPREAD | Difference |
|---------|-----------|--------|------------|--------------|------------|
| MIAMI   | 6         | 79.5   |            |              |            |
| INDIANA | 1         | 94.7   | -9.0       | -8.5         | 0.5        |

| MIAMI                       | RANK / 68 |
|-----------------------------|-----------|
| Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play |           |
| Offense Overall             | 19        |
| Rushing Offense             | 0.3 24    |
| Passing Offense             | 28.2 8    |
| Defense Overall             | 5         |
| Rushing Defense             | 1.7 4     |
| Passing Defense             | 31.0 6    |

**2025 GAME LOG**

| OPPONENT                 | S/U | Result | Score | ATS | Vegas Line | Game Grader | Yardage | Opp.-Adj., Per-Play              |
|--------------------------|-----|--------|-------|-----|------------|-------------|---------|----------------------------------|
| A. 30 OLD DOMINION       | W   | 27-14  |       |     | -23.5      | L           | 78.1    | 502 5.6 314 7 188 -1.3 0.9 -0.3  |
| S. 6 KENNESAW ST         | W   | 56-9   |       |     | -35.5      | W           | 89.4    | 593 8.9 271 5.1 322 3.7 3.1 0.7  |
| S. 12 INDIANA ST (FC)    | W   | 73-0   |       |     | -47.5      | W           | 74.7    | 680 10.2 77 1.5 603 8.6 2.7 2.3  |
| S. 20 ILLINOIS           | W   | 63-10  |       |     | -6         | W           | 123.4   | 579 8.0 161 3.6 418 4.5 2.7 2.3  |
| S. 27 @ Iowa             | W   | 20-15  |       |     | -8         | L           | 79.1    | 337 5.4 284 4.1 53 1.3 0.8 1.2   |
| O. 4 --- BYE ---         |     |        |       |     |            |             |         |                                  |
| O. 11 @ Oregon           | W   | 30-20  |       |     | 7          | W           | 92.8    | 326 4.8 267 4.2 59 0.6 0.4 2.7   |
| O. 18 MICHIGAN ST        | W   | 38-13  |       |     | -26.5      | L           | 79.5    | 464 8.3 367 5.9 97 2.4 2.3 -0.5  |
| O. 25 UCLA               | W   | 56-6   |       |     | -27.5      | W           | 96.1    | 475 6.3 201 3.8 274 2.5 0.2 1.4  |
| N. 1 @ Maryland          | W   | 55-10  |       |     | -21.5      | W           | 94.6    | 588 7.8 293 5.9 295 2 2.2 -0.4   |
| N. 8 @ Penn State        | W   | 27-24  |       |     | -14        | L           | 64.5    | 326 5.3 336 5.3 -10 0 0.1 0.5    |
| N. 15 WISCONSIN          | W   | 31-7   |       |     | -28.5      | L           | 98.6    | 388 6.3 168 3.7 220 2.5 0.8 0.6  |
| N. 22 --- BYE ---        |     |        |       |     |            |             |         |                                  |
| N. 28 @ Purdue           | W   | 56-3   |       |     | -28.5      | W           | 91.0    | 548 10.2 282 3.8 266 6.3 3.6 1.5 |
| D. 6 (B10 CG) OHIO STATE | W   | 13-10  |       |     | 3.5        | W           | 70.7    | 340 6.0 322 5.8 18 0.2 2.0 1.0   |
| J. 1 *ALABAMA (CFP)      | W   | 38-3   |       |     | -7.5       | W           | 132.4   | 407 6.2 193 3.9 214 2.3 1.3 1.7  |
| J. 9 *OREGON (CFP)       | W   | 56-22  |       |     | -3         | W           | 113.9   | 362 6.0 378 5.7 -16 0.3 1.6 1.1  |
| J. 19 *MIAMI (CFP)       |     |        |       |     |            |             | -9.0 6  |                                  |

**SITUATIONAL SPLITS**

|                  | LAST 3 YEARS (2022-2024) |       |       |       | 2025 SEASON |       |        |       | SPLIT ACTIVE |
|------------------|--------------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------------|-------|--------|-------|--------------|
|                  | S/U                      | ATS   | S/U   | ATS   | S/U         | ATS   | S/U    | ATS   | THIS WEEK    |
| After A Bye      | 1-4                      | 0.200 | 1-4   | 0.200 | 2-0-0       | 1.000 | 2-0-0  | 1.000 |              |
| After A Loss     | 5-11                     | 0.313 | 8-8   | 0.500 | 0-0         |       | 0-0-0  |       |              |
| After A Win      | 11-7                     | 0.611 | 10-8  | 0.556 | 14-0-0      | 1.000 | 10-4-0 | 0.714 | YES          |
| Vs. Ranked       | 0-8                      | 0.000 | 3-5   | 0.375 | 5-0-0       | 1.000 | 5-0-0  | 1.000 | YES          |
| All Games        | 18-19                    | 0.486 | 20-17 | 0.541 | 15-0-0      | 1.000 | 10-5-0 | 0.667 | YES          |
| As Away Favorite | 3-0                      | 1.000 | 3-0   | 1.000 | 4-0-0       | 1.000 | 2-2-0  | 0.500 | YES*         |
| As Away Team     | 4-11                     | 0.267 | 7-8   | 0.467 | 5-0-0       | 1.000 | 3-2-0  | 0.600 | YES*         |
| As Away Underdog | 1-11                     | 0.083 | 4-8   | 0.333 | 1-0-0       | 1.000 | 1-0-0  | 1.000 |              |
| As Favorite      | 16-1                     | 0.941 | 11-6  | 0.647 | 13-0-0      | 1.000 | 8-5-0  | 0.615 | YES          |
| As Home Favorite | 13-1                     | 0.929 | 8-6   | 0.571 | 7-0-0       | 1.000 | 4-3-0  | 0.571 |              |
| As Home Team     | 14-7                     | 0.667 | 12-9  | 0.571 | 7-0-0       | 1.000 | 4-3-0  | 0.571 |              |
| As Home Underdog | 1-6                      | 0.143 | 4-3   | 0.571 | 0-0         |       | 0-0-0  |       |              |
| As Underdog      | 2-18                     | 0.100 | 9-11  | 0.450 | 2-0-0       | 1.000 | 2-0-0  | 1.000 |              |
| Conference Game  | 11-16                    | 0.407 | 16-11 | 0.593 | 11-0-0      | 1.000 | 7-4-0  | 0.636 |              |

**Recent Series History**

| Year | Opponent | Result | Score | ATS |
|------|----------|--------|-------|-----|
| 1966 | @ Miami  | L      | 7-14  |     |
| 1964 | @ Miami  | W      | 28-14 |     |

ALL TIME: TIED 1-1 STREAK: MIAMI 1

| INDIANA                         | RANK (68) | MIAMI | RANK (68) |
|---------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----------|
| Talent Acquisition              |           |       |           |
| 5-Year High School Recruiting   | 52        | 10    |           |
| 2-Year Transfer Recruiting      | 23        | 3     |           |
| Number of 4 & 5-Stars on Roster | 60        | 16    |           |
| Number of NFL Draft Watchlist   | 12        | 4     |           |



# PICK SIX PLUS: TESTIMONIALS

Stats, results, and testimonials from the first season of Pick Six PLUS (2025):

- **SEASON WIN TOTALS: 6-1 ATS**
- **2025 PLAYOFF: 7-2 ATS**
- **GAME GRADER VS. VEGAS (1+ POINT VARIANCE): 112-100-4 (.530 ATS)**

From the 2025 Playoff Preview write-ups (7-2 ATS):

**PICK SIX PLUS: MIAMI 31, OLE Miss 26      RESULT: MIAMI 31, OLE Miss 27**

**PICK SIX PLUS: OLE Miss 35, UGA 34      RESULT: OLE Miss 39, UGA 34**



*"Pick Six Plus is essential to my prep work every week! The statistical breakdowns of every Power 4 team are fantastic. So clean and easy to read. Pick Six Plus is a must have for any bettor or hardcore college football fan!"*

**TIM MURRAY** -- VSIN ANALYST AND HOST OF VSIN'S "COLLEGE FOOTBALL BETTING PODCAST"



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**CHRIS ANDREWS** -- SOUTH POINT SPORTSBOOK DIRECTOR

**SAMPLE EDITION PDF, INFO, AND ORDERS AT [PICKSIXPREVIEWS.COM/PLUS](https://picksixpreviews.com/plus)**



## SIRIUSXM COLLEGE SPORTS RADIO



### SIRIUSXM RADIO OFF-CAMPUS "REPORT CARD"



SiriusXM Off-Campus co-hosts **Matt Schick** and **Roddy Jones** give out their preseason grades and superlatives. Tune in to SiriusXM Channel 84 every Wednesday at 5:30pm ET during the season to hear Pick Six Previews' **Brett Ciancia** give his weekly analysis and Game Grader projections for upcoming matchups

|                        | ACC               |                   | BIG 12             |                    | BIG TEN             |                      | SEC                 |                     |
|------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|--------------------|--------------------|---------------------|----------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
|                        | MATT              | RODDY             | MATT               | RODDY              | MATT                | RODDY                | MATT                | RODDY               |
| BEST PASSER            | MENSAH, MIAMI     | MENSAH, MIAMI     | FIFITA, ARIZONA    | MESTEMAKER, OK ST  | MOORE, OREGON       | MOORE, OREGON        | CHAMBLISS, OLE MISS | CHAMBLISS, OLE MISS |
| BEST DUAL-THREAT       | JENNINGS, SMU     | JENNINGS, SMU     | DAMPIER, UTAH      | DAMPIER, UTAH      | COLANDREA, NEB.     | WILLIAMS, UW         | BROWN, AUBURN       | CHAMBLISS, OLE MISS |
| OFFENSIVE WEAPON       | TONEY, MIAMI      | TONEY, MIAMI      | MARTIN, BYU        | MARTIN, BYU        | SMITH, OHIO STATE   | SMITH, OHIO STATE    | LACY, OLE MISS      | LACY, OLE MISS      |
| JOE MOORE O-LINE       | MIAMI             | VIRGINIA          | BYU                | BYU                | OHIO STATE          | MINNESOTA            | GEORGIA             | OKLAHOMA            |
| BEST PASS RUSHER       | ABOU JAOUDE, UNC  | LUBIN, LOUISVILLE | WHITE, TEXAS TECH  | TRICK, TEXAS TECH  | SMITH, MINNESOTA    | UIAGALELEI, OREGON   | SIMMONS, TEXAS      | SIMMONS, TEXAS      |
| FRESHMAN PHENOM        | CANTWELL, MIAMI   | CANTWELL, MIAMI   | OBOT, UTAH         | GUYTON, TEXAS TECH | HITER, MICHIGAN     | ELEE, MARYLAND       | CURTIS, VANDERBILT  | KEYS, TENNESSEE     |
| SOPHOMORE STAR         | WESCO, CLEMSON    | TONEY, MIAMI      | GREGORY, KANSAS ST | HAWKINS, OK ST     | DAK. MOORE, OREGON  | WASHINGTON, MARYLAND | PICKETT, LSU        | TAYLOR, MS STATE    |
| IMPACT TRANSFER        | BARKATE, MIAMI    | HAYNES, GA TECH   | SCUDERO, COLORADO  | HARRIS, ARIZONA ST | DALEY, MICHIGAN     | HOOVER, INDIANA      | UMANMIELEN, LSU     | COLEMAN, TEXAS      |
| NEW HOUSEHOLD NAME     | BROWN, LOUISVILLE | WILSON, MIAMI     | COOK, WVU          | SATUALA, BYU       | PERICH, OREGON      | BECKER, INDIANA      | BROWN, LSU          | BROOKS, ALABAMA     |
| BEST COACHING HIRE     | FRANKLIN, VA TECH | FRANKLIN, VA TECH | KLEIN, KANSAS ST   | KOTELNICKI, KANSAS | KELLY, NORTHWESTERN | WHITTINGHAM, MICH.   | KIFFIN, LSU         | SUMRALL, FLORIDA    |
| BEST PLAYCALLER        | HETHERMAN, MIAMI  | LASHLEE, SMU      | KOTELNICKI, KANSAS | RODERICK, BYU      | SHANAHAN, INDIANA   | SHANAHAN, INDIANA    | HEUPEL, TENNESSEE   | VENABLES, OKLAHOMA  |
| TOUGHEST PLACE TO PLAY | CLEMSON           | NC STATE          | BYU                | UTAH               | OREGON              | OREGON               | TEXAS A&M           | LSU                 |
| BEST ROAD TRIP         | VIRGINIA TECH     | VIRGINIA TECH     | COLORADO           | COLORADO           | MICHIGAN            | PENN STATE           | LSU at NIGHT        | GEORGIA             |



# RECRUITING: 5-YEAR AVERAGE

Like it or not, it all starts with recruiting. Everyone has their own opinion on recruiting rankings, and here is how I view it:

Can the recruiting ratings miss on an individual prospect? Yes, it happens all the time. Some 5-star players will never contribute on the field, while some 2-stars and walk-ons will earn All-American honors. Remember, “J.J. Watt was a 2-star.”

However, over the course of a 25-man signing class, the total numbers are more right than wrong. And then when you stack five classes in a row and fill out the 85-man scholarship roster, there is some value there.

As you’ll read on the following pages, this is just the starting point. It’s up to the coaching staffs to develop the raw talent and convert it into on-field success and wins. Recruiting is not the whole formula, but it is the starting point and is a necessary backbone to a program that wants to compete for national championships.

## RECRUITING RANKINGS: 5-YEAR AVERAGE (Class rankings via 247Sports)

|              |                   |                    |                 |                 |
|--------------|-------------------|--------------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| 1 ALABAMA    | 13 FLORIDA        | 25 KENTUCKY        | 37 MINNESOTA    | 49 BYU          |
| 2 GEORGIA    | 14 CLEMSON        | 26 TEXAS TECH      | 38 ILLINOIS     | 50 LOUISVILLE   |
| 3 TEXAS      | 15 FLORIDA STATE  | 27 IOWA            | 39 WASHINGTON   | 51 COLORADO     |
| 4 OHIO STATE | 16 AUBURN         | 28 TEXAS CHRISTIAN | 40 GEORGIA TECH | 52 HOUSTON      |
| 5 OREGON     | 17 SOUTH CAROLINA | 29 MARYLAND        | 41 NC STATE     | 53 OKLA. STATE  |
| 6 NOTRE DAME | 18 OLE MISS       | 30 STANFORD        | 42 WISCONSIN    | 54 SYRACUSE     |
| 7 LSU        | 19 PENN STATE     | 31 UTAH            | 43 BAYLOR       | 55 PITTSBURGH   |
| 8 MIAMI      | 20 USC            | 32 VIRGINIA TECH   | 44 VANDERBILT   | 56 DUKE         |
| 9 OKLAHOMA   | 21 MISSOURI       | 33 MICHIGAN STATE  | 45 INDIANA      | 57 WAKE FOREST  |
| 10 TEXAS A&M | 22 NORTH CAROLINA | 34 NEBRASKA        | 46 KANSAS STATE | 58 ARIZONA ST   |
| 11 TENNESSEE | 23 MISS. STATE    | 35 WEST VIRGINIA   | 47 ARIZONA      | 59 PURDUE       |
| 12 MICHIGAN  | 24 ARKANSAS       | 36 RUTGERS         | 48 IOWA STATE   | 60 UCF          |
|              |                   |                    |                 | 61 CINCINNATI   |
|              |                   |                    |                 | 62 N'WESTERN    |
|              |                   |                    |                 | 63 UCLA         |
|              |                   |                    |                 | 64 BOSTON COLL. |
|              |                   |                    |                 | 65 CAL          |
|              |                   |                    |                 | 66 SMU          |
|              |                   |                    |                 | 67 KANSAS       |
|              |                   |                    |                 | 68 VIRGINIA     |

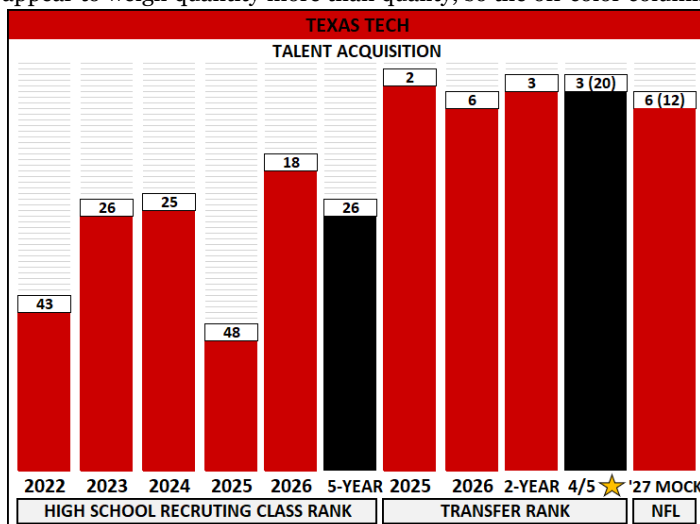
On each team preview page, I have included a “Talent Acquisition” graphic. It shows the past five high school recruiting class rankings along with the five-year ranking.

Next I included the past two transfer class rankings, the two-year ranking, and then a column to show the number of four-star and five-star transfer players. The transfer class rankings appear to weigh quantity more than quality, so the off-color column shows the pure quality.

The final column shows the number of players currently forecasted to be selected in the 2027 NFL Draft – a consensus of the top mock drafts as of July.

Texas Tech head coach Joey McGuire, and their Matador Club NIL collective, went all-in on the transfer portal in 2025 and again in 2026. They signed 20 four-star transfers – the average Big 12 program signed 2 – and reloaded after their historic season.

For example, this graphic shows that Texas Tech is #26 in high school recruiting over the past five years, #3 in transfer class ranks over the past two years, signed 20 four-star & five-star transfers (#3 most), and currently has 6 players on the consensus 2027 NFL mock draft (#6 most).





# PLAYER DEVELOPMENT & WIN CONVERSION

So a program lands a strong recruiting class, and even starts to stack consecutive top-rated classes over a few years. What's next? Player development and converting the raw talent into wins on the field.

Intuitively, you can picture some programs that are great developers, and which ones seem to always squander that February signing day hype.

To quantify this, I compare the raw recruiting rankings to both the NFL Draft output and the total wins.

## **Player Development:** Recruit Rank (2019-2022) vs. NFL Draft Picks (2023-2026)

If a program signs a bunch of 2-stars and ends up high on the NFL Draft pick lists, you know they are developing their players above expectation. Similarly, if a program signs a bunch of 5-stars and is relatively low on the NFL Draft list, it would appear they are not developing and maximizing player potential.

## **Win Conversion:** Recruit Rank (2017-2025) vs. Total Wins (2021-2025)

This stat compares the program's recruiting level to their actual output in the win column. Some programs sign top classes and still can't win games. That speaks volumes to the staff's coaching style, playcalling, system, in-game adjustments, and overall ability.

These stats are especially insightful at the extreme ends: the Top 12 and Bottom 12. A team like Ohio State that is #1 in recruiting, and also #1 in Draft Picks and #1 in Wins would be a net zero in these categories, and fall somewhere in the middle-of-the pack. They are performing right at their expectation level.

### WIN CONVERSION

|    |              |    |               |
|----|--------------|----|---------------|
| 1  | SMU          | 68 | AUBURN        |
| 2  | BYU          | 67 | NEBRASKA      |
| 3  | KANSAS STATE | 66 | STANFORD      |
| 4  | TEXAS TECH   | 65 | FLORIDA       |
| 5  | LOUISVILLE   | 64 | MISS. STATE   |
| 6  | IOWA         | 63 | VIRGINIA TECH |
| 7  | UTAH         | 62 | ARKANSAS      |
| 8  | MINNESOTA    | 61 | COLORADO      |
| 9  | WASHINGTON   | 60 | MARYLAND      |
| 10 | HOUSTON      | 59 | FLORIDA STATE |
| 11 | ILLINOIS     | 58 | UNC           |
| 12 | WAKE FOREST  | 57 | TEXAS A&M     |



### PLAYER DEVELOPMENT

|    |                |    |               |
|----|----------------|----|---------------|
| 1  | ILLINOIS       | 68 | NEBRASKA      |
| 2  | TEXAS TECH     | 67 | WEST VIRGINIA |
| 3  | KANSAS STATE   | 66 | UNC           |
| 4  | PITTSBURGH     | 65 | MISS. STATE   |
| 5  | ARIZONA        | 64 | BAYLOR        |
| 6  | LOUISVILLE     | 63 | VANDERBILT    |
| 7  | TCU            | 62 | WISCONSIN     |
| 8  | BOSTON COLL.   | 61 | VIRGINIA      |
| 9  | USC            | 60 | COLORADO      |
| 10 | IOWA           | 59 | OKLAHOMA ST   |
| 11 | WASHINGTON     | 58 | GEORGIA TECH  |
| 12 | SOUTH CAROLINA | 57 | STANFORD      |

On each team preview page, I have included the program's all-time history, wins over certain long-term intervals, and draft picks over the last 10 and 20 years.

Win Conversion and Player Development are both also included at the bottom of the graphics.

Despite a recruiting rank usually in the #50 to #60 range, Kansas State and Chris Klieman's staff have proven themselves as consistent, top-notch player developers.



| KANSAS STATE                                                   |       | RANK / 68 |  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-----------|--|
| All-Time Wins                                                  | 586   | 59        |  |
| All-Time Win %                                                 | 0.464 | 64        |  |
| Wins (Last 100)                                                | 467   | 60        |  |
| Wins (Last 50)                                                 | 317   | 38        |  |
| Wins (Last 25)                                                 | 187   | 29        |  |
| Wins (Last 10)                                                 | 76    | 24        |  |
| Wins (Last 5)                                                  | 42    | 18        |  |
| Game Grader (10 yr)                                            | 54.0  | 26        |  |
| Game Grader (5 yr)                                             | 60.8  | 14        |  |
| Game Grader (3 yr)                                             | 60.1  | 22        |  |
| Draft Picks s' 2000                                            | 61    | 41        |  |
| Draft Picks s' 2010                                            | 30    | 50        |  |
| Player Development: Recruit Rank ('19-'22) vs. Draft ('23-'26) |       | 3         |  |
| Win Conversion: Recruit Rank ('17-'25) vs. Wins ('21-'25)      |       | 3         |  |





# GAME GRADER: 2025 RESULTS

Often times, the win/loss record doesn't paint the full picture of a team's performance over the course of a season. In the same sense, the final score of a game by itself only scratches the surface of what occurred that day. Two different 9-win teams have different schedules, non-conference slates of varying difficulty, and maybe an extra league game.

I needed a way to numerically dig deeper into a team's game/season performance, adjusted for opponent-strength.

After scraping through thousands of box scores and game stats dating back to 1994, I eventually developed my Game Grader formula.

Essentially, several game stats are factored in including yardage differential, turnover margin, yardage per play differential, opponent adjustments, pace adjustments, and scoring margin, among others. Depending on how dominant the team's statistical performance was, they are graded on a scale of 1 to 100. Then, the raw score is adjusted for the opponent's strength, explaining how a team can receive a grade over 100, or how a near-perfect game can fall below 100 if the opponent was weak.

Over the course of 12-16 games and data points, I arrive at a season average (2025 results shown below).

You can intuitively picture some teams that seemed better or worse than their win/loss record, or some teams that left winnable games on the field (and vice versa). Game Grader accounts for all of that, and is factored into my prediction logic.

|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |               |      |    |                   |      |
|----|------------|------|----|-----------------|------|----|---------------|------|----|-------------------|------|
| 1  | INDIANA    | 91.8 | 16 | IOWA            | 64.0 | 31 | CLEMSON       | 55.2 | 46 | KENTUCKY          | 45.1 |
| 2  | OHIO STATE | 86.8 | 17 | VIRGINIA        | 63.7 | 32 | IOWA STATE    | 54.9 | 47 | CINCINNATI        | 44.7 |
| 3  | TEXAS TECH | 84.3 | 18 | ARIZONA         | 63.6 | 33 | GEORGIA TECH  | 54.7 | 48 | SOUTH CAROLINA    | 44.4 |
| 4  | NOTRE DAME | 83.7 | 19 | BYU             | 63.4 | 34 | WAKE FOREST   | 54.0 | 49 | KANSAS            | 44.2 |
| 5  | OREGON     | 81.5 | 20 | LOUISVILLE      | 63.3 | 35 | HOUSTON       | 53.9 | 50 | FLORIDA           | 42.9 |
| 6  | MIAMI      | 78.8 | 21 | MISSOURI        | 62.8 | 36 | ARIZONA STATE | 53.1 | 51 | CALIFORNIA        | 42.4 |
| 7  | GEORGIA    | 74.9 | 22 | TEXAS           | 62.7 | 37 | DUKE          | 52.5 | 52 | UCF               | 41.9 |
| 8  | OLE MISS   | 74.8 | 23 | SMU             | 62.0 | 38 | AUBURN        | 52.3 | 53 | MISSISSIPPI STATE | 41.8 |
| 9  | TEXAS A&M  | 73.1 | 24 | TENNESSEE       | 59.1 | 39 | LSU           | 51.3 | 54 | RUTGERS           | 41.5 |
| 10 | UTAH       | 72.3 | 25 | FLORIDA STATE   | 59.0 | 40 | NC STATE      | 50.3 | 55 | MINNESOTA         | 40.3 |
| 11 | VANDERBILT | 70.2 | 26 | MICHIGAN        | 58.7 | 41 | KANSAS STATE  | 49.5 | 56 | MARYLAND          | 38.9 |
| 12 | USC        | 67.5 | 27 | PENN STATE      | 58.3 | 42 | NORTHWESTERN  | 47.6 | 57 | MICHIGAN STATE    | 38.3 |
| 13 | OKLAHOMA   | 66.3 | 28 | ILLINOIS        | 57.7 | 43 | BAYLOR        | 46.9 | 58 | WEST VIRGINIA     | 35.9 |
| 14 | ALABAMA    | 66.1 | 29 | PITTSBURGH      | 56.7 | 44 | ARKANSAS      | 46.0 | 59 | NORTH CAROLINA    | 34.9 |
| 15 | WASHINGTON | 64.4 | 30 | TEXAS CHRISTIAN | 56.4 | 45 | NEBRASKA      | 45.9 | 60 | WISCONSIN         | 34.2 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |               |      | 61 | VIRGINIA TECH     | 33.8 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |               |      | 62 | UCLA              | 31.5 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |               |      | 63 | COLORADO          | 31.4 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |               |      | 64 | BOSTON COLLEGE    | 30.9 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |               |      | 65 | STANFORD          | 28.8 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |               |      | 66 | SYRACUSE          | 27.8 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |               |      | 67 | PURDUE            | 27.3 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |               |      | 68 | OKLAHOMA STATE    | 20.4 |

On each team preview page, I have included the program's 2025 results: list of games, score, yardage differential, turnover margin, and finally, the Game Grade. In the bottom row, I have included the team's 2025 Game Grader rank out of the 68 Power 4 programs, and also their rank within the conference. This helps give context to the raw score/numbers.

Purdue's 2022 season was an interesting case study for my Game Grader. They won a division title, yet finished well below average – and outside the national Top 40 – in Game Grader. Their seven FBS wins were by an average margin of just seven points/game, five were within a score, and they were even out-gained in three of them.

Not all division champions are created equal. In the bowl game, SEC West champs LSU beat them 63-7 – the biggest blowout in bowl history.

As a forward-looking tool, Game Grader correctly forecasted a slide from first to last in the 2023 West Division for Purdue.

| PURDUE             |         |                  |        |       |  |
|--------------------|---------|------------------|--------|-------|--|
| 2022 RESULTS       |         | Yard +/-         | TO +/- | GRADE |  |
| PENN ST            | L 31-35 | 20               | 0      | 54.9  |  |
| INDIANA ST         | W 56-0  | 376              | 2      | FCS   |  |
| SYRACUSE           | L 29-32 | 179              | -1     | 54.4  |  |
| FAU                | W 28-26 | -65              | 0      | 35.9  |  |
| MINNESOTA          | W 20-10 | 55               | 0      | 81.3  |  |
| MARYLAND           | W 31-29 | -14              | -2     | 50.1  |  |
| NEBRASKA           | W 43-37 | 132              | 1      | 64.8  |  |
| WISCONSIN          | L 24-35 | 50               | -2     | 38.7  |  |
| IOWA               | L 3-24  | -121             | -2     | 16.9  |  |
| ILLINOIS           | W 31-24 | 76               | 0      | 77.9  |  |
| N'WESTERN          | W 17-9  | 59               | 3      | 58.1  |  |
| INDIANA            | W 30-16 | -33              | 1      | 55.8  |  |
| (CG) MICHIGAN      | L 22-43 | 70               | -1     | 37.8  |  |
| (B) LSU            | L 7-63  | -331             | -2     | 0.0   |  |
| OVERALL: 44th / 69 |         | BIGTEN: 9th / 14 |        | 48.2  |  |



# GAME GRADER: 3-YEAR AVERAGE

I applied the Game Grader formula back to all Power 4 games and seasons since 2010, and all national champions and runner-ups since 1994. The historical numbers help show how the current staff/team are performing within their program context.

|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |                |      |    |                |      |
|----|------------|------|----|-----------------|------|----|----------------|------|----|----------------|------|
| 1  | OHIO STATE | 84.6 | 16 | SMU             | 62.4 | 31 | ARIZONA STATE  | 51.3 | 46 | UCLA           | 45.0 |
| 2  | OREGON     | 82.4 | 17 | LOUISVILLE      | 62.3 | 32 | SOUTH CAROLINA | 50.5 | 47 | VANDERBILT     | 44.9 |
| 3  | NOTRE DAME | 79.5 | 18 | USC             | 62.2 | 33 | ILLINOIS       | 50.5 | 48 | BAYLOR         | 44.9 |
| 4  | GEORGIA    | 78.1 | 19 | WASHINGTON      | 62.2 | 34 | GEORGIA TECH   | 50.2 | 49 | KENTUCKY       | 44.6 |
| 5  | TEXAS      | 75.6 | 20 | TEXAS TECH      | 61.5 | 35 | FLORIDA STATE  | 50.1 | 50 | UNC            | 44.4 |
| 6  | OLE MISS   | 74.3 | 21 | LSU             | 61.3 | 36 | DUKE           | 49.4 | 51 | PITTSBURGH     | 44.3 |
| 7  | MIAMI      | 70.7 | 22 | KANSAS STATE    | 60.1 | 37 | AUBURN         | 48.9 | 52 | RUTGERS        | 44.1 |
| 8  | PENN STATE | 69.9 | 23 | CLEMSON         | 59.7 | 38 | UCF            | 48.3 | 53 | COLORADO       | 43.8 |
| 9  | ALABAMA    | 69.7 | 24 | IOWA STATE      | 57.2 | 39 | NEBRASKA       | 48.1 | 54 | VIRGINIA       | 43.7 |
| 10 | MICHIGAN   | 65.5 | 25 | UTAH            | 56.5 | 40 | FLORIDA        | 47.5 | 55 | MARYLAND       | 43.5 |
| 11 | MISSOURI   | 64.6 | 26 | TEXAS CHRISTIAN | 56.1 | 41 | NC STATE       | 47.1 | 56 | WEST VIRGINIA  | 43.4 |
| 12 | TEXAS A&M  | 64.1 | 27 | ARIZONA         | 55.6 | 42 | VIRGINIA TECH  | 46.2 | 57 | CINCINNATI     | 42.8 |
| 13 | INDIANA    | 64.1 | 28 | BYU             | 55.3 | 43 | ARKANSAS       | 45.5 | 58 | WISCONSIN      | 42.5 |
| 14 | TENNESSEE  | 63.7 | 29 | IOWA            | 55.1 | 44 | MINNESOTA      | 45.4 | 59 | HOUSTON        | 41.5 |
| 15 | OKLAHOMA   | 62.8 | 30 | KANSAS          | 53.1 | 45 | CALIFORNIA     | 45.0 | 60 | NORTHWESTERN   | 40.9 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |                |      | 61 | SYRACUSE       | 39.8 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |                |      | 62 | BOSTON COLL.   | 39.7 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |                |      | 63 | WAKE FOREST    | 38.2 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |                |      | 64 | OKLAHOMA ST    | 35.0 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |                |      | 65 | MISSISSIPPI ST | 34.6 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |                |      | 66 | MICHIGAN ST    | 33.7 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |                |      | 67 | PURDUE         | 27.1 |
|    |            |      |    |                 |      |    |                |      | 68 | STANFORD       | 26.3 |

**NEW GRAPHIC:** On each team preview page, I added the program's 2026 position rankings. It shows every unit's ranking within the conference, and the green right column shows if the unit made the National Top 15.

Oregon has the top defensive line in the Big Ten and the #1 line in the nation. They have the #4 offensive line in the Big Ten – good for #6 nationally. This will save time from flipping back to the conference cover sheet that shows the position/unit rankings.

When I launched *Pick Six Previews* in 2012, Indiana was stuck at the bottom of the Big Ten every year, but head coach Curt Cignetti brought in 50+ new players and led an instant breakthrough. The 2024 team held their first AP Top 5 ranking in 60 years and earned a Playoff bid. The 2025 team went a perfect 16-0 to win their first National Title and Heisman.

| OREGON          |   | UNIT RANKS |  |
|-----------------|---|------------|--|
| BIG TEN RANK    |   | NATIONAL   |  |
| (of 18)         |   | TOP 15     |  |
| QUARTERBACK     | 1 | 2          |  |
| RUNNING BACKS   | 3 | 9          |  |
| RECEIVERS & TE  | 2 | 5          |  |
| OFFENSIVE LINE  | 4 | 6          |  |
| DEFENSIVE LINE  | 1 | 1          |  |
| LINEBACKERS     | 3 | 14         |  |
| DEFENSIVE BACKS | 1 | 1          |  |

| INDIANA  |          |           |           | GAME GRADER (RANK / 68) |         |           |           |           |           |           |
|----------|----------|-----------|-----------|-------------------------|---------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 2025     | 2024     | 2023      | 2022      | 2021                    | 2020    | 2019      | 2018      | 2017      | 2016      | 10-YEAR   |
| 91.8 (1) | 72.8 (8) | 27.6 (65) | 23.4 (67) | 22.8 (65)               | 56 (28) | 50.3 (32) | 43.1 (55) | 43.9 (48) | 45.8 (41) | 47.7 (44) |



# GAME GRADER: COACH CAROUSEL

Most national pundits rush to give Coaching Carousel “grades” minutes after the hire. The transition season doesn’t always paint an accurate picture. We need to see multiple seasons and multiple recruiting/transfer cycles.

Now, with two or more years of on-field performance, we can begin to numerically grade the hires. Using my Game Grader formula, I pulled the coach’s season average, and compared to the four-year average prior to his arrival. I include the prior years to provide program context to illustrate the situation that each coach was inheriting.

| Team              | Coach    | 4-Year Prior | 2-Year Average | Impact |
|-------------------|----------|--------------|----------------|--------|
| INDIANA           | CIGNETTI | 32.5         | 82.3           | 49.8   |
| DUKE              | DIAZ     | 38.7         | 47.9           | 9.2    |
| ARIZONA           | BRENNAN  | 39.8         | 48.7           | 8.9    |
| TEXAS A&M         | ELKO     | 59.7         | 66.6           | 7.0    |
| SYRACUSE          | BROWN    | 35.8         | 42.7           | 6.9    |
| BOSTON COLLEGE    | O'BRIEN  | 38.0         | 37.8           | -0.2   |
| HOUSTON           | FRITZ    | 46.2         | 45.7           | -0.4   |
| MICHIGAN STATE    | SMITH    | 38.6         | 37.1           | -1.5   |
| WASHINGTON        | FISCH    | 60.3         | 58.4           | -1.9   |
| MISSISSIPPI STATE | LEBBY    | 48.7         | 34.2           | -14.5  |
| MICHIGAN          | MOORE    | 71.3         | 54.1           | -17.2  |
| ALABAMA           | DeBOER   | 85.7         | 69.0           | -16.7  |
| UCLA              | FOSTER   | 61.0         | 37.3           | -23.7  |

Curt Cignetti won a National Title with the sport's all-time losing program -- shattering our Coach Impact record

| Team          | Coach          | 4-Year Prior | 3-Year Average | Impact |
|---------------|----------------|--------------|----------------|--------|
| GEORGIA TECH  | KEY            | 28.3         | 50.2           | 21.9   |
| COLORADO      | SANDERS        | 30.6         | 43.8           | 13.2   |
| LOUISVILLE    | BROHM          | 52.0         | 62.3           | 10.4   |
| NEBRASKA      | RHULE          | 42.5         | 48.1           | 5.6    |
| NORTHWESTERN  | BRAUN          | 36.3         | 40.9           | 4.6    |
| ARIZONA STATE | DILLINGHAM     | 50.0         | 51.3           | 1.3    |
| AUBURN        | FREEZE         | 51.7         | 48.9           | -2.8   |
| STANFORD      | TAYLOR (2-yr)  | 35.4         | 25.1           | -10.3  |
| CINCINNATI    | SATTERFIELD    | 61.5         | 42.8           | -18.7  |
| WISCONSIN     | FICKELL        | 62.7         | 42.5           | -20.2  |
| PURDUE        | WALTERS (2-yr) | 47.1         | 26.9           | -20.2  |

## 2024

| Team            | Coach          | 4-Year Prior | 4-Year Average | Impact |
|-----------------|----------------|--------------|----------------|--------|
| DUKE            | ELKO (2yr) *   | 32.4         | 54.5           | 22.1   |
| OREGON          | LANNING        | 60.1         | 78.6           | 18.5   |
| TEXAS TECH      | McGUIRE        | 45.0         | 59.7           | 14.7   |
| SMU             | LASHLEE        | 46.1         | 59.0           | 12.9   |
| TEXAS CHRISTIAN | DYKES          | 49.8         | 59.9           | 10.1   |
| USC             | RILEY          | 54.0         | 64.2           | 10.1   |
| MIAMI           | CRISTOBAL      | 52.2         | 62.1           | 9.9    |
| WASHINGTON      | DeBOER (2yr) * | 59.2         | 68.6           | 9.4    |
| NOTRE DAME      | FREEMAN        | 71.6         | 74.7           | 3.1    |
| LSU             | KELLY          | 63.8         | 62.1           | -1.6   |
| VIRGINIA TECH   | PRY            | 43.7         | 41.8           | -1.8   |
| VIRGINIA        | ELLIOTT        | 47.8         | 40.8           | -7.1   |
| OKLAHOMA        | VENABLES       | 76.5         | 61.2           | -15.3  |
| FLORIDA         | NAPIER         | 65.8         | 47.7           | -18.1  |

## 2022

| Team              | Coach            | 4-Year Prior | 6-Year Average | Impact |
|-------------------|------------------|--------------|----------------|--------|
| OLE MISS          | KIFFIN           | 44.1         | 66.5           | 22.4   |
| ARKANSAS          | PITTMAN          | 29.9         | 49.0           | 19.1   |
| RUTGERS           | SCHIANO          | 20.2         | 36.5           | 16.3   |
| MISSOURI          | DRINKWITZ        | 50.7         | 53.4           | 2.7    |
| BAYLOR            | ARANDA           | 47.9         | 49.6           | 1.7    |
| FLORIDA STATE     | NORVELL          | 49.4         | 48.3           | -1.1   |
| MISSISSIPPI STATE | LEACH (3yr) *    | 54.5         | 53.1           | -1.4   |
| BOSTON COLLEGE    | HAFLEY (4yr) *   | 44.8         | 38.0           | -6.9   |
| MICHIGAN STATE    | TUCKER (3yr) *   | 52.9         | 42.5           | -10.4  |
| COLORADO          | DORRELL (3yr) *  | 43.6         | 28.2           | -15.5  |
| WASHINGTON STATE  | ROLOVICH (2yr) * | 58.8         | 41.5           | -17.3  |
| WASHINGTON        | LAKE (2yr) *     | 71.7         | 52.0           | -19.7  |

## 2020

## 2023

| Team           | Coach          | 4-Year Prior | 5-Year Average | Impact |
|----------------|----------------|--------------|----------------|--------|
| TENNESSEE      | HEUPEL         | 36.2         | 64.0           | 27.9   |
| ILLINOIS       | BIELEMA        | 28.7         | 52.5           | 23.7   |
| KANSAS         | LEIPOLD        | 21.8         | 44.7           | 22.9   |
| SOUTH CAROLINA | BEAMER         | 39.9         | 48.1           | 8.2    |
| ARIZONA        | FISCH (3yr) *  | 37.2         | 45.3           | 8.1    |
| VANDERBILT     | LEA            | 29.4         | 37.1           | 7.7    |
| TEXAS          | SARKISIAN      | 62.4         | 69.2           | 6.8    |
| UCF            | MALZAHN (4yr)  | 67.8         | 51.1           | -16.7  |
| AUBURN         | HARSIN (2yr) * | 62.4         | 45.0           | -17.4  |

## 2021

| Team           | Coach               | 4-Year Prior | 7-Year Average | Impact |
|----------------|---------------------|--------------|----------------|--------|
| KANSAS STATE   | KLIEMAN             | 44.6         | 56.6           | 12.0   |
| OHIO STATE     | DAY                 | 79.0         | 86.3           | 7.3    |
| NORTH CAROLINA | BROWN (6yr) *       | 46.0         | 53.1           | 7.1    |
| MARYLAND       | LOCKSLEY            | 35.2         | 41.9           | 6.6    |
| KANSAS         | MILES (2yr) *       | 18.4         | 20.8           | 2.4    |
| LOUISVILLE     | SATTERFIELD (4yr) * | 50.7         | 52.0           | 1.2    |
| TEXAS TECH     | WELLS (3yr) *       | 47.4         | 44.4           | -3.0   |
| MIAMI          | DIAZ (3yr) *        | 58.2         | 51.7           | -6.5   |
| WEST VIRGINIA  | BROWN (6yr) *       | 59.0         | 45.2           | -13.8  |
| GEORGIA TECH   | COLLINS (4yr) *     | 47.9         | 28.3           | -19.6  |

## 2019



# 10-YEAR OFFENSE/DEFENSE TRENDS

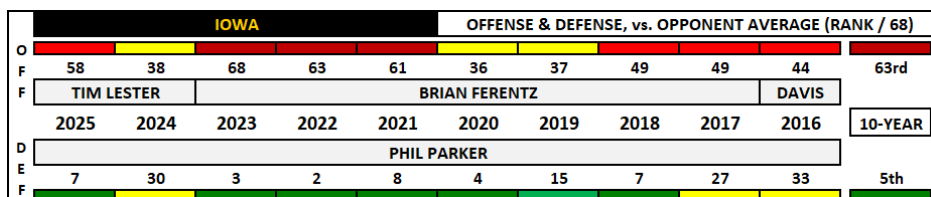
In the 2020 offseason, I developed my 10-year offense and defense trends – opponent-adjusted & per-play.

My Game Grader formula gives an overall team score, but doesn't break out between offense and defense performance. So I needed a way to adjust offensive and defensive stats and place them in the context of the team's opponent strength. Rushing for 300 yards on Clemson is not the same as rushing for 300 yards on Hawaii.

I also needed a way to adjust for pace of play. If Iowa holds a team to 200 total yards, in a slow-tempo game in which the defense faced just 50 snaps, it is not the same as if Utah holds a fast-paced, no-huddle Big 12 offense to 200 total yards on 90 snaps.

I dug through the entire 2010s decade, and compared every team's game performance to what their opponent was averaging that season. Specifically, I compared it on a per-play basis, to account for the pace of play.

That's the background and logic behind my "opponent-adjusted offense/defense metrics." I have included these 10-year graphics on every team page, and also break it out by coordinator tenure, for a quick visual to track the impacts of certain coordinators and offensive/defensive strategies.



On each team page, these graphics show their rank (out of the 68 Power 4 teams) in my opponent-adjusted, per-play metrics. Not only do they show the overall offense and defense grades, but also dig deeper with rushing and passing breakdowns.

| TEXAS TECH                  |      |    | MIAMI                       |      |    |
|-----------------------------|------|----|-----------------------------|------|----|
| RANK / 68                   |      |    | RANK / 68                   |      |    |
| Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play |      |    | Opponent-Adjusted, Per-Play |      |    |
| Offense Overall             | 24   |    | Offense Overall             | 18   |    |
| Rushing Offense             | 0.3  | 28 | Rushing Offense             | 0.5  | 21 |
| Passing Offense             | 15.2 | 22 | Passing Offense             | 27.1 | 8  |
| Defense Overall             | 1    |    | Defense Overall             | 4    |    |
| Rushing Defense             | 2.3  | 1  | Rushing Defense             | 1.7  | 3  |
| Passing Defense             | 28.2 | 8  | Passing Defense             | 33.5 | 4  |

Below, I've included the best 10-year offense and defense averages, along with the best 3-year averages for a more recent view:

| OFFENSE             |            |                    |            | DEFENSE             |            |                    |            |
|---------------------|------------|--------------------|------------|---------------------|------------|--------------------|------------|
| 10-YEAR TOP OFFENSE |            | 3-YEAR TOP OFFENSE |            | 10-YEAR TOP DEFENSE |            | 3-YEAR TOP DEFENSE |            |
| 1                   | OHIO STATE | 1                  | OREGON     | 1                   | ALABAMA    | 1                  | OHIO STATE |
| 2                   | ALABAMA    | 2                  | USC        | 2                   | GEORGIA    | 2                  | NOTRE DAME |
| 3                   | OKLAHOMA   | 3                  | NOTRE DAME | 3                   | CLEMSON    | 3                  | OKLAHOMA   |
| 4                   | OLE MISS   | 4                  | LSU        | 4                   | OHIO STATE | 4                  | TEXAS      |
| 5                   | GEORGIA    | 5                  | OHIO STATE | 5                   | IOWA       | 5                  | PENN STATE |
| 6                   | LOUISVILLE | 6                  | OLE MISS   | 6                   | NOTRE DAME | 6                  | GEORGIA    |
| 7                   | USC        | 7                  | MIAMI      | 7                   | MICHIGAN   | 7                  | OREGON     |
| 8                   | LSU        | 8                  | KANSAS     | 8                   | PENN STATE | 8                  | MICHIGAN   |
| 9                   | OREGON     | 9                  | WASHINGTON | 9                   | AUBURN     | 9                  | IOWA       |
| 10                  | NOTRE DAME | 10                 | GEORGIA    | 10                  | WASHINGTON | 10                 | ALABAMA    |





# 2026 COLLEGE FOOTBALL PLAYOFF

I ended up as one of the only national writers to defend the four-team playoff bracket size. Yes, I would have liked a tweak to the *selection process* – a transparent, agreed-upon BCS-style formula, rather than a “committee.” But in terms of bracket size, I always felt that a four-team playoff still protected the importance of the regular season.

The 13 fall Saturdays are more valuable than an expanded postseason tournament. Instead of winner-take-all matchups throughout the fall, which essentially serve as the elimination tournament within the season, we now have less October/November stakes, and more rematches in December/January.

The 2013 Iron Bowl’s Kick Six would have only shifted around some Playoff seeding instead of delivering an all-time knock-out punch to the loser. This became a reality in November 2024 when 21-point underdog Michigan dealt Ohio State its second loss in a rivalry upset for the ages. Normally that would have ruined Ohio State’s championship run, but instead, the Buckeyes landed back in the big bracket, hosted a Playoff game, and rounded into an NFL machine that won the national title.

With that said, for some of the high-stakes games we may be losing, it is only fair to account for what will be gained. Now, some games between two-loss teams are filled with Playoff stakes that would never have existed in the old system. In 2024, BYU @ Arizona State was basically a play-in game to the league title, and then Arizona State vs. Iowa State was a true play-in game for the Playoff. Hate it or love it, there are pros and cons, and it will be fascinating to see the 12-team Playoff continue into 2026.

## AUTOMATIC BIDS

The four Power 4 conference champions, plus the highest-ranked Non-AQ team (regardless of Non-AQ champion status) are awarded automatic bids. In 2024, the four highest league champs were rewarded first-round byes, but that rule is gone. The quarterfinals will be at bowl sites.

SEC: GEORGIA      BIG TEN: OREGON      BIG 12: TEXAS TECH      ACC: MIAMI      NON-AQ: BOISE ST

## AT-LARGE BIDS

After those five champion spots are filled, the committee will select the seven “at-large” bids awarded to the highest remaining teams. If history is any precedent, they will value conference strength, and the SEC and Big Ten have earned multiple bids in past years. This year I see the SEC and Big Ten each getting four selections. Most “at-large” bids play first-round games hosted by the better-seeded team. My projection calls for on-campus Playoff games in Lubbock, Norman, Bloomington and Athens.

TEXAS @ TEXAS TECH      BOISE STATE @ OKLAHOMA      OLE MISS @ INDIANA      USC @ NOTRE DAME



## BEST PLAYOFF TEAMS (GAME GRADER, SINCE 2014)

| RANK | TEAM       | YEAR | RANK | TEAM       | YEAR | RANK | TEAM       | YEAR | RANK | TEAM            | YEAR | RANK | TEAM           | YEAR |
|------|------------|------|------|------------|------|------|------------|------|------|-----------------|------|------|----------------|------|
| 1    | ALABAMA    | 2020 | 14   | CLEMSON    | 2016 | 27   | TEXAS      | 2023 | 40   | MICHIGAN        | 2021 | 53   | GEORGIA        | 2024 |
| 2    | OHIO STATE | 2019 | 15   | ALABAMA    | 2021 | 28   | CLEMSON    | 2020 | 41   | PENN STATE      | 2024 | 54   | TENNESSEE      | 2024 |
| 3    | ALABAMA    | 2016 | 16   | OHIO STATE | 2025 | 29   | TEXAS      | 2024 | 42   | OKLAHOMA        | 2018 | 55   | ARIZONA STATE  | 2024 |
| 4    | LSU        | 2019 | 17   | OHIO STATE | 2014 | 30   | OREGON     | 2025 | 43   | GEORGIA         | 2025 | 56   | OKLAHOMA       | 2025 |
| 5    | CLEMSON    | 2018 | 18   | CLEMSON    | 2017 | 31   | ALABAMA    | 2014 | 44   | OLE MISS        | 2025 | 57   | ALABAMA        | 2025 |
| 6    | GEORGIA    | 2022 | 19   | TEXAS TECH | 2025 | 32   | OKLAHOMA   | 2015 | 45   | NOTRE DAME      | 2018 | 58   | SMU            | 2024 |
| 7    | ALABAMA    | 2018 | 20   | OKLAHOMA   | 2017 | 33   | WASHINGTON | 2016 | 46   | TEXAS A&M       | 2025 | 59   | JAMES MADISON  | 2025 |
| 8    | ALABAMA    | 2015 | 21   | OREGON     | 2014 | 34   | OHIO STATE | 2020 | 47   | INDIANA         | 2024 | 60   | MICHIGAN STATE | 2015 |
| 9    | INDIANA    | 2025 | 22   | GEORGIA    | 2017 | 35   | MIAMI      | 2025 | 48   | TEXAS CHRISTIAN | 2022 | 61   | FLORIDA STATE  | 2014 |
| 10   | GEORGIA    | 2021 | 23   | ALABAMA    | 2017 | 36   | OKLAHOMA   | 2019 | 49   | ALABAMA         | 2023 | 62   | BOISE STATE    | 2024 |
| 11   | OHIO STATE | 2024 | 24   | MICHIGAN   | 2022 | 37   | OHIO STATE | 2016 | 50   | CINCINNATI      | 2021 | 63   | CLEMSON        | 2024 |
| 12   | MICHIGAN   | 2023 | 25   | OHIO STATE | 2022 | 38   | OREGON     | 2024 | 51   | WASHINGTON      | 2023 | 64   | TULANE         | 2025 |
| 13   | CLEMSON    | 2019 | 26   | CLEMSON    | 2015 | 39   | NOTRE DAME | 2024 | 52   | NOTRE DAME      | 2020 |      |                |      |



# 2026 RANKINGS: POWER 4



|              |               |                   |                  |                   |                   |
|--------------|---------------|-------------------|------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| 1 OREGON     | 11 USC        | 21 SMU            | 31 KANSAS STATE  | 41 NC STATE       | 51 WEST VIRGINIA  |
| 2 OHIO STATE | 12 LSU        | 22 UTAH           | 32 ARIZONA STATE | 42 FLORIDA STATE  | 52 BAYLOR         |
| 3 MIAMI      | 13 TEXAS A&M  | 23 CLEMSON        | 33 ARIZONA       | 43 MISS. STATE    | 53 WAKE FOREST    |
| 4 NOTRE DAME | 14 MICHIGAN   | 24 IOWA           | 34 VIRGINIA TECH | 44 MINNESOTA      | 54 DUKE           |
| 5 GEORGIA    | 15 TENNESSEE  | 25 TCU            | 35 VIRGINIA      | 45 KENTUCKY       | 55 NORTHWESTERN   |
| 6 OKLAHOMA   | 16 ALABAMA    | 26 AUBURN         | 36 WISCONSIN     | 46 VANDERBILT     | 56 MARYLAND       |
| 7 TEXAS      | 17 BYU        | 27 MISSOURI       | 37 NEBRASKA      | 47 OKLAHOMA STATE | 57 NORTH CAROLINA |
| 8 TEXAS TECH | 18 WASHINGTON | 28 SOUTH CAROLINA | 38 ILLINOIS      | 48 UCF            | 58 ARKANSAS       |
| 9 INDIANA    | 19 LOUISVILLE | 29 FLORIDA        | 39 PITTSBURGH    | 49 UCLA           | 59 MICHIGAN STATE |
| 10 OLE MISS  | 20 PENN STATE | 30 HOUSTON        | 40 GEORGIA TECH  | 50 CALIFORNIA     | 60 CINCINNATI     |
|              |               |                   |                  |                   | 61 KANSAS         |
|              |               |                   |                  |                   | 62 COLORADO       |
|              |               |                   |                  |                   | 63 RUTGERS        |
|              |               |                   |                  |                   | 64 SYRACUSE       |
|              |               |                   |                  |                   | 65 IOWA STATE     |
|              |               |                   |                  |                   | 66 STANFORD       |
|              |               |                   |                  |                   | 67 BOSTON COLLEGE |
|              |               |                   |                  |                   | 68 PURDUE         |

## MOST ACCURATE PREVIEW MAGAZINE

Stassen.com has graded college football preview magazines and websites for decades and provides the established “Preseason Prediction Accuracy” rankings. Stassen posts the prediction rankings every season, as well as in 3-year, 5-year, and 10-year intervals.

2022 was my first year eligible for the 10-year standings, and I placed #1 in America. Not only that, but I ranked #1 in the 3-year and 5-year standings for the elusive Stassen Triple Crown. *Pick Six Previews* became just the third to ever accomplish that feat in the 30+ years Stassen has been grading publications.

Here is the official Stassen 10-year graphic:

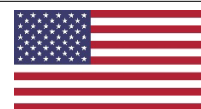
**10-YEAR #1 MOST ACCURATE: 2022, 2023, 2024, AND AGAIN 2025**

### Preseason Prediction Accuracy (2016-2025)

| Magazine                | Rank | Total Score | 2025  | 2024  | 2023  | 2022  | 2021  | 2020  | 2019  | 2018  | 2017  | 2016  |
|-------------------------|------|-------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| Pick Six Previews       | 1    | 2,094.1     | 346.5 | 344.5 | 225   | 167.5 | 169   | 160.1 | 135.5 | 119   | 150.5 | 141.5 |
| Athlon                  | 2    | 2,094.4     | 341   | 348   | 218   | 172   | 180   | 183.4 | 127   | 109   | 146   | 137   |
| Phil Steele             | 3    | 2,109.1     | 353   | 339   | 221.5 | 176   | 174   | 160.1 | 121.5 | 126.5 | 158.5 | 148   |
| McIllece Sports         | 4    | 2,123       | 342   | 350.5 | 216.5 | 160   | 183   | 185.5 | 120   | 132.5 | 156   | 147   |
| DRatings.com            | 5    | 2,125.5     | 314   | 353   | 229   | 174   | 175   | 186   | 127   | 114.5 | 149   | 148   |
| Arena Fanatic           | 6    | 2,135.9     | 331   | 370.5 | 226.5 | 188   | 169.5 | 178.9 | 132.5 | 132   | 134   | 145.5 |
| ESPN                    | 7    | 2,164.9     | 339   | 389   | 244   | 174   | 188   | 181.9 | 109   | 126   | 133   | 146   |
| Lindy's                 | 8    | 2191.1      | 358   | 368   | 218   | 177   | 190   | 187.1 | 127   | 120   | 157   | 148   |
| Versus Sports Simulator | 9    | 2,236       | 358   | 385.5 | 216.5 | 168   | 176.5 | 191   | 140   | 129.5 | 159.5 | 154.5 |
| CollegeFootballPoll.com | 10   | 2,277.5     | 353.5 | 373.5 | 237.5 | 184   | 201   | 196   | 127   | 131   | 162.5 | 150   |



# 2026 ALL-AMERICA TEAM



In 2020, I was invited to join the FWAA's All-America Team selection committee. The FWAA's team is one of the five official teams, along with the AP, AFCA (coaches), Sporting News, and Walter Camp.

It was an honor to participate in the 2020-2025 selection process alongside 12 of the best college football writers in America, and I am looking forward to this December for the 2026 team. The preseason teams I've selected below are a mid-summer snapshot -- once the season kicks off I throw it out and evaluate purely on 2026 performance.

## OFFENSE

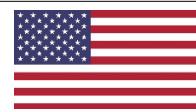
| 1st TEAM |                    |            | 2nd TEAM |                  |            |
|----------|--------------------|------------|----------|------------------|------------|
| QB       | TRINIDAD CHAMBLISS | OLE MISS   | QB       | DANTE MOORE      | OREGON     |
| RB       | AHMAD HARDY        | MISSOURI   | RB       | LJ MARTIN        | BYU        |
| RB       | KEWAN LACY         | OLE MISS   | RB       | JORDAN MARSHALL  | MICHIGAN   |
| WR       | JEREMIAH SMITH     | OHIO STATE | WR       | DUCE ROBINSON    | FLORIDA ST |
| WR       | MALACHI TONEY      | MIAMI      | WR       | MARIO CRAVER     | TEXAS A&M  |
| WR       | CAM COLEMAN        | TEXAS      | WR       | ISAIAH SATEGNA   | OKLAHOMA   |
| TE       | TREY'DEZ GREEN     | LSU        | TE       | BENJAMIN BRAHMER | PENN STATE |
| OL       | CARTER SMITH       | INDIANA    | OL       | CAYDEN GREEN     | MISSOURI   |
| OL       | IAPANI LALOULU     | OREGON     | OL       | EVAN TENGESDAHL  | CINCINNATI |
| OL       | KADE PIEPER        | IOWA       | OL       | AUSTIN SIEREVELD | OHIO STATE |
| OL       | ANTHONIE KNAPP     | NOTRE DAME | OL       | DREW BOBO        | GEORGIA    |
| OL       | TREVOR GOOSBY      | TEXAS      | OL       | CHARLES JAGUSAH  | NOTRE DAME |

## OFFENSE

| 3rd TEAM |                 |            | 4th TEAM |                |            |
|----------|-----------------|------------|----------|----------------|------------|
| QB       | JULIAN SAYIN    | OHIO STATE | QB       | CJ CARR        | NOTRE DAME |
| RB       | MARK FLETCHER   | MIAMI      | RB       | JADAN BAUGH    | FLORIDA    |
| RB       | ANTWAN RAYMOND  | RUTGERS    | RB       | JORDON DAVISON | OREGON     |
| WR       | RYAN WINGO      | TEXAS      | WR       | BRAYLON STALEY | TENNESSEE  |
| WR       | DANNY SCUDERO   | COLORADO   | WR       | AMARE THOMAS   | HOUSTON    |
| WR       | CHARLIE BECKER  | INDIANA    | WR       | EVAN STEWART   | OREGON     |
| TE       | TERRANCE CARTER | TEXAS TECH | TE       | JAMARI JOHNSON | OREGON     |
| OL       | TREVOR LAUCK    | IOWA       | OL       | PATRICK KUTAS  | OLE MISS   |
| OL       | JOHN MILLS      | WASHINGTON | OL       | McKALE BOLEY   | VIRGINIA   |
| OL       | GREG JOHNSON    | MINNESOTA  | OL       | CARSON HINZMAN | OHIO STATE |
| OL       | JORDAN SEATON   | LSU        | OL       | EARNEST GREENE | GEORGIA    |
| OL       | PJ WILLIAMS     | SMU        | OL       | DAVID SANDERS  | TENNESSEE  |



# 2026 ALL-AMERICA TEAM



## DEFENSE

| 1st TEAM |                  |             | 2nd TEAM |                    |            |
|----------|------------------|-------------|----------|--------------------|------------|
| DL       | JOHN HENRY DALEY | MICHIGAN    | DL       | AJ HOLMES          | TEXAS TECH |
| DL       | COLIN SIMMONS    | TEXAS       | DL       | DAVID STONE        | OKLAHOMA   |
| DL       | DYLAN STEWART    | S. CAROLINA | DL       | A'MAURI WASHINGTON | OREGON     |
| DL       | TYRIQUE TUCKER   | INDIANA     | DL       | ANTHONY SMITH      | MINNESOTA  |
| LB       | XAVIER ATKINS    | AUBURN      | LB       | ROLIJAH HARDY      | INDIANA    |
| LB       | SAMMY BROWN      | CLEMSON     | LB       | CHRIS COLE         | GEORGIA    |
| LB       | RASHEEM BILES    | TEXAS       | LB       | RAYLEN WILSON      | GEORGIA    |
| DB       | LEONARD MOORE    | NOTRE DAME  | DB       | BRAY HUBBARD       | ALABAMA    |
| DB       | ELLIS ROBINSON   | GEORGIA     | DB       | AMARE FERRELL      | INDIANA    |
| DB       | KJ BOLDEN        | GEORGIA     | DB       | BRANDON FINNEY     | OREGON     |
| DB       | KOI PERICH       | OREGON      | DB       | ZABIEN BROWN       | ALABAMA    |

## DEFENSE

| 3rd TEAM |                     |            | 4th TEAM |                   |            |
|----------|---------------------|------------|----------|-------------------|------------|
| DL       | WILL ECHOLES        | OLE MISS   | DL       | TAYLOR WEIN       | OKLAHOMA   |
| DL       | MELKART ABOU JAOUDE | UNC        | DL       | AHMAD MOTEN       | MIAMI      |
| DL       | P. UMANMIELEN       | LSU        | DL       | BEAR ALEXANDER    | OREGON     |
| DL       | ANTO SAKA           | TEXAS A&M  | DL       | MATAYO UIAGALELEI | OREGON     |
| LB       | KIP LEWIS           | OKLAHOMA   | DL       | MARIO LANDINO     | INDIANA    |
| LB       | AUSTIN ROMAINE      | TEXAS TECH | DL       | CLEV LUBIN        | LOUISVILLE |
| LB       | SUNTARINE PERKINS   | OLE MISS   | LB       | BEN ROBERTS       | TEXAS TECH |
| LB       | ISAIAH JONES        | INDIANA    | LB       | K. VILIAMU-ASA    | NOTRE DAME |
| DB       | PEYTON BOWEN        | OKLAHOMA   | DB       | JYAIR HILL        | MICHIGAN   |
| DB       | JELANI McDONALD     | TEXAS      | DB       | DEVIN SANCHEZ     | OHIO STATE |
| DB       | BRICE POLLOCK       | TEXAS TECH | DB       | EARL LITTLE       | OHIO STATE |

## 2026 ALL-TRANSFER TEAM

|    |                  |                |   |               |    |                       |                |   |              |
|----|------------------|----------------|---|---------------|----|-----------------------|----------------|---|--------------|
| QB | DARIAN MENSAH    | Duke           | → | MIAMI         | DL | JOHN HENRY DALEY      | Utah           | → | MICHIGAN     |
| RB | JUSTICE HAYNES   | Michigan       | → | GEORGIA TECH  | DL | PRINCEWILL UMANMIELEN | Ole Miss       | → | LSU          |
| WR | CAM COLEMAN      | Auburn         | → | TEXAS         | DL | ANTO SAKA             | Northwestern   | → | TEXAS A&M    |
| WR | ISAIAH HORTON    | Alabama        | → | TEXAS A&M     | DL | DAMON WILSON          | Missouri       | → | MIAMI        |
| WR | NICK MARSH       | Michigan State | → | INDIANA       | DL | WENDELL GREGORY       | Oklahoma State | → | KANSAS STATE |
| WR | OMARION MILLER   | Colorado       | → | ARIZONA ST    | LB | RASHEEM BILES         | Pittsburgh     | → | TEXAS        |
| TE | BENJAMIN BRAHMER | Iowa State     | → | PENN STATE    | LB | AUSTIN ROMAINE        | Kansas State   | → | TEXAS TECH   |
| OL | JORDAN SEATON    | Colorado       | → | LSU           | LB | CADE ULUAVE           | California     | → | BYU          |
| OL | LANCE HEARD      | Tennessee      | → | KENTUCKY      | DB | KOI PERICH            | Minnesota      | → | OREGON       |
| OL | COLETON PRICE    | Baylor         | → | KENTUCKY      | DB | KOEN ENTRINGER        | Iowa           | → | LOUISVILLE   |
| OL | JACARRIUS PEAK   | NC State       | → | S. CAROLINA   | DB | JONTEZ WILLIAMS       | Iowa State     | → | USC          |
| OL | XAVIER CHAPLIN   | Auburn         | → | FLORIDA STATE | DB | EARL LITTLE           | Florida State  | → | OHIO STATE   |





# TOP UNITS: NATIONAL

On each conference cover page, I include unit rankings per position group within each league.

Here are the Top 15 nationally:

| OFFENSE        |                 |                           |                 |
|----------------|-----------------|---------------------------|-----------------|
| QUARTERBACK    | RUNNING BACK    | WIDE RECEIVER / TIGHT END | OFFENSIVE LINE  |
| 1 OLE MISS     | 1 MISSOURI      | 1 OHIO STATE              | 1 NOTRE DAME    |
| 2 OREGON       | 2 OLE MISS      | 2 MIAMI                   | 2 OHIO STATE    |
| 3 OHIO STATE   | 3 MICHIGAN      | 3 TEXAS                   | 3 INDIANA       |
| 4 NOTRE DAME   | 4 TEXAS         | 4 TEXAS A&M               | 4 GEORGIA       |
| 5 MIAMI        | 5 MIAMI         | 5 OREGON                  | 5 IOWA          |
| 6 GEORGIA      | 6 TEXAS TECH    | 6 FLORIDA                 | 6 OREGON        |
| 7 TEXAS        | 7 USC           | 7 CLEMSON                 | 7 TENNESSEE     |
| 8 SMU          | 8 GEORGIA       | 8 LSU                     | 8 MIAMI         |
| 9 WASHINGTON   | 9 OREGON        | 9 OKLAHOMA                | 9 TEXAS TECH    |
| 10 USC         | 10 BYU          | 10 TEXAS TECH             | 10 USC          |
| 11 ARIZONA     | 11 GEORGIA TECH | 11 TENNESSEE              | 11 CINCINNATI   |
| 12 TEXAS A&M   | 12 LOUISVILLE   | 12 USC                    | 12 MICHIGAN     |
| 13 PENN STATE  | 13 OHIO STATE   | 13 ALABAMA                | 13 TEXAS        |
| 14 OKLAHOMA    | 14 FLORIDA      | 14 OLE MISS               | 14 BYU          |
| 15 OKLAHOMA ST | 15 RUTGERS      | 15 INDIANA                | 15 GEORGIA TECH |

| DEFENSE        |               |                 |
|----------------|---------------|-----------------|
| DEFENSIVE LINE | LINEBACKERS   | DEFENSIVE BACKS |
| 1 OREGON       | 1 GEORGIA     | 1 OREGON        |
| 2 OKLAHOMA     | 2 INDIANA     | 2 OKLAHOMA      |
| 3 NOTRE DAME   | 3 TEXAS TECH  | 3 GEORGIA       |
| 4 MIAMI        | 4 NOTRE DAME  | 4 NOTRE DAME    |
| 5 INDIANA      | 5 OLE MISS    | 5 ALABAMA       |
| 6 GEORGIA      | 6 CLEMSON     | 6 TEXAS A&M     |
| 7 OHIO STATE   | 7 BYU         | 7 MIAMI         |
| 8 TEXAS        | 8 TENNESSEE   | 8 MICHIGAN      |
| 9 TEXAS TECH   | 9 AUBURN      | 9 OHIO STATE    |
| 10 LSU         | 10 TEXAS      | 10 INDIANA      |
| 11 OLE MISS    | 11 OKLAHOMA   | 11 TEXAS        |
| 12 USC         | 12 LSU        | 12 LSU          |
| 13 MICHIGAN    | 13 OHIO STATE | 13 BYU          |
| 14 TEXAS A&M   | 14 OREGON     | 14 TEXAS TECH   |
| 15 LOUISVILLE  | 15 WASHINGTON | 15 UTAH         |